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CORE RUSH

Dig down. Get rich. Don't trust the clock.

Core Rush is a free pixel-art mining game you play in your browser: drill down through six layers, haul ore back up to sell and upgrade your pod. Drill into the dark, fill your hold with ore, fly it back up to sell, and pour the cash into a bigger drill, a longer tank and a brighter lamp. Then go deeper.

Someone has dug here before you. They left notes in the rock, and they seem to know an awful lot about you. Something at the bottom of the world is keeping time, and it might not be the first time you've heard it tick.

FEATURES

- Six layers to dig through, from the soft Topsoil and the glittering Crystal Caverns to the Magma Belt, the Ancient Ruins and deeper places that shouldn't exist

- 9 ores to haul, from coal and copper to gold, platinum and a couple of things nobody has a name for

- 6 pod upgrades: Drill, Tank, Hold, Hull, Lamp and Thrust

- Dynamite, repair kits and an emergency teleporter for when things go wrong

- Watch your fuel gauge: run dry and the tow truck will haul you up, for a fee

- Cave-ins, falling rock, lava and the darkness itself

- 12 hidden field notes to find. Read them all. Something is different every time you come back

- A music track for every layer, plus chunky pixel art and synthesized sound

- Progress saves automatically in your browser

CONTROLS

- A / D or Left / Right: move

- W / Up / Space: thrust

- S / Down: drill (hold Left or Right against a wall to drill sideways)

- E: interact (fuel station, shop, sell counter, notes)

- 1 / 2 / 3: dynamite / repair kit / teleporter

- Esc: pause

- On phones and tablets, on-screen buttons appear

Free to play right in your browser on desktop or phone.

Made with AI assistance: the code and graphics were generated with Grok, then play-tested and tuned by me.

Want to make your own? Core Rush's real build prompt and its playtest fix prompt (the one that set the $150-$250 first trip) are printed in my guide, along with every other lesson from making six games with AI as a non-coder.
How I Made 6 Browser Games with AI: https://bluewater78.itch.io/how-i-made-6-games-with-ai (also on Gumroad: https://bluewater78.gumroad.com/l/olxrdg)

More information

Development log

Core Rush is out: dig down, get rich, don't trust the clock 6 days ago

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